

Everything Happens; Spencer Hit to Left Crosses Up Amarillo

By BOB INGRAM

No matter how they finish in the standings, the Sun Kings likely will remember their 13-12 victory over the Amarillo Sonics as one of their big games of the 1967 season in the Texas League. They had to come from behind three times, once by seven runs, to achieve it and narrow Amarillo's first place lead over the Kings to one game. Arkansas, by beating Albuquerque 8-2, is in second a half game out.

It was a key win, last night's contest, agreed Rocky Bridges and Moose Stubing. Andy Cohen called it a "fans' game."

Both Rocky and Buddy Hanc-ken played it like it was the final and deciding game of the championship season. Amarillo used 17 players and El Paso 16 — a total of 33. Eleven pitchers went to the mound — six of the Kings and five of Amarillo. There were moves and counter moves. The game took 3 hours, 20 minutes.

ERIC SPELMAN backed into his second victory of the season. Twice he was given leads and twice he surrendered them but he still was the winning pitcher.

A tabulation of some of the other strange things about the game will include: Jim Spencer's run-tying double to the opposite field in the ninth. Mike Sinnerud's faux pas in the eighth inning. The Amarillo third baseman, with two Sun Kings down, thought there were runners on first and second. When Vic LaRose grounded to him, Sinnerud stepped on third, for what he thought was a force out, and started to the dugout. The Kings scored a go-ahead run as a result. Sinnerud almost shed his goat horns for a hero's mantle when he singled home Amarillo's go-ahead run in the top of the ninth. But the Kings counted two in the bottom of the ninth to win.

THE SECOND game of the series is slated tonight with Andy Messersmith due to hurl for the Kings and Rick Pierini slated for Amarillo action.

In last night's game in which the Kings scored a baker's dozen to an ordinary dozen by Amarillo, Don Wilkinson drove the ball to right field to bring Spencer home with the winning run with nobody out in the bottom of the ninth. The victim was George Gerberman, No. 5 of the Amarillo pitchers.

The key to the ninth inning comeback of the Sun Kings could be Spencer's double, a surprise left field hit. The Sun Kings first baseman's power is all to right field. But last night he didn't swing for the fences but stroked the ball to left field as though he was placing it. That crossed up the Sonics whose outfielders were pulled way around to the right.

IT HELPED, of course, to have Jarvis Tatum on first base. In fact, if Rocky had his pick of the whole squad the fleet footed Tatum would have been his choice to be on base at the time. Tatum had opened the bottom of the ninth with a right field single.

When Spencer hit his double, Tatum set a speed record for flying around the bases. He

scored to tie it up and then Wilkinson's single brought Spencer in for the win.

The Kings, playing before a crowd of 5406, which was made up mostly of kids there for the second Scholarship Night, practically blew the game in the opening two innings. The Sonics scored seven runs off Paul Jaekel and Rick Evans. But then over a stretch of five innings with Jim Holbrook and Dave Turnbull doing some splendid relieving, the Sonics were held scoreless.

THE KINGS meantime got three unearned runs in the second and three more in the third. All three of the latter were driven in on Dennis Paepke's homer, his first of the season. He was spelling Tom Egan for the night.

The Kings tied it in the fifth 7-7 when Paepke doubled and scored on Vic LaRose's single. They went ahead one with Gordon Avery scoring an unearned run after beating out an infield hit in the sixth.

The score was 8-7 in El Paso's favor in the top of the eighth when the Sonics went to bat. Spelman, who had come on in relief, hit Bull Watson and walked Sinnerud. Then Pierini, batting for pitcher Gary Dotter, doubled both runners home. And then scored on Fred Walters' single. The Kings, thanks to Sinnerud's mental lapse, went ahead 11-10. But it was short lived with Spelman walking the lead off man in the ninth, Lee Bales, Watson delivering a double and Sinnerud getting a single.

Amarillo led 12-11 when the Sun Kings came to bat in the bottom of the ninth.

Amarillo	ab	r	h	bi	El Paso	ab	r	h	bi
McDonald, 2b	5	2	2	0	Avery, 2b	6	1	3	2
Bales, ss	2	2	0	0	Tatum, lf	6	1	1	0
Davis, cf	5	1	2	2	Spencer, lb	4	2	2	1
Sessins, c	0	0	0	0	Wilkinson, rf	6	1	2	1
Watson, lb	4	3	4	4	Rodriguez, 3b	5	2	1	0
Colbert, lf	4	1	0	0	Paepke, c	4	4	2	3
Sinnerud, 3b	5	1	1	1	Trevino, cf	4	2	2	0
Griffin, c	4	0	0	0	LaRose, ss	4	0	1	2
Vigano, rf	3	0	2	1	Jaekel, p	0	0	0	0
Futch, ph	0	0	0	0	Evans, p	0	0	0	0
Coyil, p	0	0	0	0	Shubin, ph	0	0	0	0
Dotter, p	0	0	0	0	Holbrook, p	0	0	0	0
Pierini, ph	1	1	1	2	Turnbull, p	1	0	0	0
Gerberman, p	0	0	0	0	Boehlert, p	0	0	0	0
Kroll, p	2	0	1	0	Newman, ph	1	0	0	0
Harrar, p	0	0	0	0	Spelman, p	1	0	1	1
Walters, ph	2	0	1	1					

Totals 39 12 14 11 Totals 42 13 16 10

AMARILLO		520	005	032	-12
EL PASO		633	011	032	-13
E—La Rose, Bales, Trevino, Watson 2.					
D—Rodriguez to Spencer, L.O.B.—Amarillo					
13, El Paso 10, 2B—Paepke, Pierini, Wat-					
son, Trevino, Spencer, 3B—Davis, Watson,					
HR—Paepke (1), 5B—Colbert, McDonald					
2, Davis, Watson 2, S—Sessins, Futch,					
SP—LaRose					

	IP	H	R	ER	BB	SO
Kroll	4 1/3	6	7	4	4	4
Harrar	1 2/3	2	1	0	1	2
Coyil	1	2	0	0	0	0
Dotter	2 2/3	1	2	0	0	0
Gerberman, L. (24)	1 1/3	5	3	2	0	0
Jaekel	1 2/3	4	5	4	2	0
Evans	1 1/3	2	2	2	2	0
Holbrook	4	3	0	0	2	3
Turnbull	2 2/3	1	1	0	0	1
Boehlert	1 1/3	0	0	0	0	0
Spelman, W (2-0)	2	4	5	5	2	0

HBP—Watson (Holbrook), Watson (Spelman), WP—Harrar, Gerberman, Umpires—Schirra and Walsh, Time—3:20, Attendance 5406.

ARKANSAS		231	000	002	-8
ALBUQUERQUE		000	000	200	-2
Friel and Smith; Roberts, Lamb (2),					
Armstrong (3), Morgan (8) and Sizemore,					
LP—Roberts					

DALLAS-F. W.		610	200	000	-9
ALICEA					